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THE LEGACY BEARERS

As India observes National Reading Month, a peek into two popular used-books shops in Chennai that survive because the women running them want to preserve what has been bequeathed to them, despite daunting odds **P4&5**



COMFORT WHEELS

Kilpauk resident P.R.M.M. Shanthakumar and his team are called on for assistance during bereavement and health crisis involving celebrities. His vehicle transported director K. Bhagyaraj's body from hospital to home **P6**

A tribute to three timeless legends of Tamil music

An apartment in Thiruvanniyur and a cultural group from Besant Nagar team up to present a musical evening on June 28 in Adyar



Anand Apartments in Thiruvanniyur, in association with Besant Nagar-based Kadarkarai Kaalai Raagam (KKR365), will be presenting a musical tribute to three icons of Tamil cinema – Kaviyarasar Kannadasan, Mellisai Mannar M.S. Viswanathan, and Paadum Nila S.P. Balasubrahmanyam—on June 28, 2026 at 5.30 p.m at Hotel Matsya, Gandhi Nagar, Adyar.

The event commemorates the birth centenary year of Kaviyarasar Kannadasan and the birth month celebrations of M.S. Viswanathan and S.P. Balasubrahmanyam, honouring their en-



during contribution to Tamil music and culture.

Anand Apartments, a vibrant residential community of over 150 families on L.B. Road, has celebrated arts, culture and community through its annual festivities for over four decades. KKR365 is a unique community of nearly 100 music lovers from diverse backgrounds who gather every morning at Besant Nagar Beach to keep the golden era of Tamil film music alive through singing songs.

Jointly organised by N. Raman (Anand Apartments) and Chandrasekaran (KKR365), this special programme, with an investment of approximately ₹1.5 lakh, is expected to be a memorable cultural celebration, said a release.

For details call Chandrasekaran at +919444627370

READERS WRITE

Signboard on Lattice Bridge Road misleading

C. DHANASEKARAN

A signboard on Lattice Bridge Road, along Mahatma Gandhi Road in Shastri Nagar, Adyar, is misleading motorists.

Those coming from Mahatma Gandhi Road should ideally turn right to Lattice Bridge Road to proceed to a section, but the signboard indicates that this is not the route. The motorists are startled on seeing the board and halt along the junction to check the maps on their phones to reach Adyar. Apart from rectifying the error, at First Main Road, Shastri Nagar, signboards must be placed indicating which lanes on Mahatma Gandhi Road to take to reach Adyar and Thiruvanniyur regions.

At times, motorists proceeding towards Adyar drive on the lane towards Thiruvanniyur, affecting traffic flow towards Adyar to access the Adyar lane. This affects the traffic flow, as motorists halt all of a sudden, and collisions can occur.

The same situation prevails for motorists proceeding towards Thiruvanniyur on the



The point where motorists get confused.

Adyar lane. Motorists on the lane towards Adyar, proceeding towards Thiruvanniyur, and vice versa, take free left and right turns rashly and speedily, without noticing the traffic flow, and

overtaking their counterparts.

C. Dhanasekaran is a resident of Adyar

More 'Readers Write' stories on page 2

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Sewage work leaves Nookampalayam Road in a mess



K T MANICHANDAR

On Nookampalayam Link Road in Semmencheri, work on laying sewage lines has been under way for some years.

The road to and from the Ambrosia Apartment (near Satyabama University, OMR) is basted with mud, and is not fit for walking or driving. The rains that lashed the city on June 17 exposed the state of the road.

It is a nightmare for children and the elderly to cross muddy stretch without slipping. While laying a proper road would take time, we request the authorities to take up patchwork so that motorists and pedestrians can use the stretch.

K T Manichandar is a resident of Semmencheri

Road in PTC-Thoraipakkam not relaid for years



These images are just a sample of the deplorable state of Gokilambal Nagar Main Road and Alagappa Nagar at PTC-Thoraipakkam (Ward 195). The road has not been relaid for over seven years. Following the underground drainage works, its condition has deteriorated significantly,

leaving the entire stretch filled with potholes and uneven surfaces. Commuting has become extremely difficult, especially for two-wheeler riders, and the situation poses a serious safety risk.

Every day, dozens of school buses use this road,

putting the safety of school-children and other commuters at risk. With the monsoon already under way, the condition of the road is expected to worsen further, increasing the likelihood of accidents and vehicle damage.

Residents of Gokilambal Nagar / Alagappa Nagar



Book Swap: stories on the move

The gathering coincided with the 21st OMR Book Swap, a reader-driven initiative that gives books a second life by encouraging participants to exchange completed titles for new ones. This edition saw nearly 150 books find new homes. The success of the swap was made possible by volunteers Anitha, Madhmitha, Sharmishtha, Gokulakannan, Poornima, Harishkumar, Darshika, the team Casa Grand Amethyst Arun, Raghavi, Naveen, Mounika, Ravi among others. We also thank Sriram, Sunitha and Ramasamy for contributing towards the boxes for safekeeping of the 1000 books between swaps.

Book Breakout: spotlight on Ram Naam Satya Hai

Ram Naam Satya Hai, the debut novel of OMR resident Renu Chhotaria, was launched during the meet. In conversation with FOMRRA volunteer Ranjit Narayanan, the author shared insights into her modern mythological interpretation of the Ramayana. The book revisits several contentious episodes from the epic through a contemporary storytelling lens, sparking lively discussions among members who offered diverse perspectives on the themes explored in the novel.

Shutterbugs join bookworms at OMR

HARSHA KODA

The major highlight of the latest meeting of The Booworms Club was the launch of a club that would help photographers, professional and amateur, on OMR to meet and share notes

The Bookworms Club, the literary arm of FOMRRA, held its 8th meeting on June 14, 2026, at Casa Grand Amethyst, Sholinganallur, bringing together readers, nature enthusiasts, and residents for an engaging afternoon of books and discussion.

Book Breakdowns: Where the Crawdads Sing

A lively discussion centred on Delia Owens' bestselling novel *Where the Crawdads Sing*, selected for the meet by Sriram Janak, a nature and wildlife photographer from OMR. Set in the marshlands of North Carolina during the 1960s, the novel blends crime, survival and nature writing through the story of a young girl growing up in isolation. Members also compared the book with its successful film adaptation, concluding that the novel's vivid depiction of marshland life and human resilience offered a richer experience than the movie's stronger emphasis on the mystery plot.

In keeping with the book's environmental themes, Bhuvana Raj, a lead member of FOMRRA's Eco Watch initiative, shared insights on marshland ecosystems and the importance of protecting habitats such as the Pallikaranai Marsh. She highlighted the impact of rapid urbanisation and stressed the need for residents to safeguard these natural buffers against flooding and other ecological challenges.

Seeing the interest among the crowd for the visual beauty of the marsh FOMRRA also launched the ShutterBugs group to showcase and discuss photography among members. (<https://shutterbugs.fomrra.org>)

The meeting concluded with members selecting Jane Austen's classic *Sense and Sensibility* as the book for the next gathering, continuing the club's tradition of collectively choosing its next literary journey.

The legacy bearers

As India observes National Reading Month from June 19 to July 18, a peek into two popular used-books shops in Chennai that survive because the women running them want to preserve what has been bequeathed to them, despite daunting odds

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

R.K. Alwar did not want his books to be interred with his bones; and that was his final wish, not expressed on his deathbed but when he realised he was doddering towards it. Alwar's daughters Ammu and Julie have honoured that wish against daunting odds, ensuring the iconic Alwar Book Shop stays rooted to the spot where it has always stood at Luz Church Road in Mylapore. Alwar passed on in 2018 and since then his daughters have witnessed a parade of reasons to go back on their promise. If they had, nobody could have faulted them for it. The pandemic tested their resolve and the ongoing Metro Rail work has done the same thing. But these events had only ended up playing the devil's advocate, revealing to the world that this resolve comes with a cladding of steel.

Around Luz Corner and on this section of Luz Church Road, multiple retail businesses have trotted away in disappointment, but the duo has held on bound by that promise. Metro Rail construction has made Alwar Book Shop difficult to access, barricades and route diversions have discouraged many regulars from visiting it, and the once bustling pavement book shop is marked by a con-



(Above) Alwar's four daughters (from left) Eliza, Ammu, Julie and Lucy at Alwar Book Shop; and Alwar with his family.

spicuous lull. And changing reading habits induced by digital technology is queering the pitch further. But get this right, the daughters bear Alwar's legacy (which is their mother Ma-

ry's too; she also passed on in 2018) not as a burden, but as believers in it. There are believers from outside the family too. For them, Alwar's affable nature makes it compelling to believe

in his legacy and dream, which began in 1939. Ammu points out there are still a good number of customers best described as "loyal patrons"; they continue visiting the book shop because of their affection for Alwar.

The sisters take turns to look after the book shop both living just a stone's throw away from it for easy accessibility and for the unstated reason of refreshing memories. Family time has been around this shop. After marriage, Mary joined Alwar in managing the shop. Ammu recalls her maternal grandmother worked as a nanny at Good Shepherd Convent and, as a child her mother often accompanied her to the school, gradually acquiring English language with its myriad nuances. Though neither of their parents had extensive formal education, their love for literature was immense. "Our mother spoke English beautifully, and both our parents knew books and authors better than most people I have met," Ammu recalls in a tone betraying boundless admiration.

For their father, the bookstore was never merely a business; it provided him with meaning for existence; it was a dream he gave his youth away for. Ammu remembers how her father never spent a single night away from the shop and would brave torrential downpours to ensure not even a corner of a shop got drenched. She laughs while recalling, "He loved books so much that he would absent-mindedly call almost everything a book, even if it was a piece of cloth."

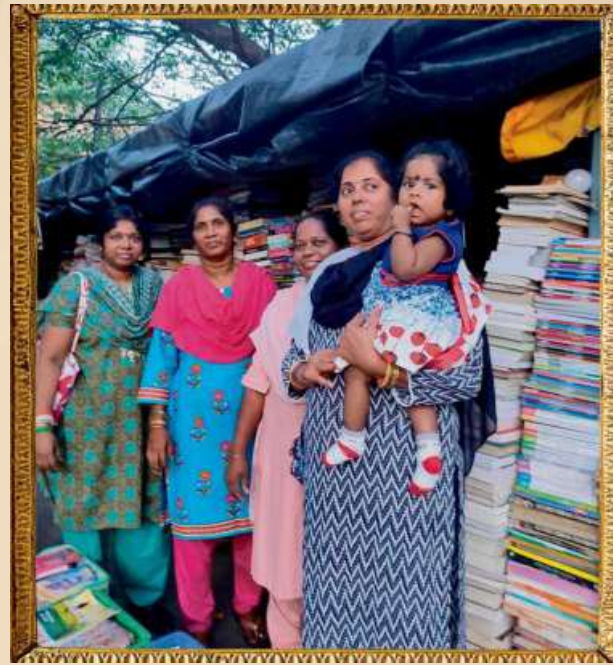
Perhaps the irony is the greatest story at the Alwar Book Shop is not inside any of those

thousands of books lining its shelves, and it is unwritten. This story is lived out every day by two daughters: returning to the same spot, made hallow by his father for those who worship learning and knowledge.

Ammu believes their father has never truly left the bookstore he established at this spot when he was around 16 years old.

Her voice choking and tears in her eyes, Ammu adds, "My dad is still here. We know he is. That is why we will never give up on this shop, even on our hardest days."

Alwar Book Shop, open from 10 a.m. to 7:30 p.m., offering fiction, non-fiction and academic books can be contacted at 9884773591



Scrap dealers probably do not warm up to old books with the same intensity as before; but surprises do crop up

The neighbourhood Kabadiwala as the bookseller

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Before the digital revolution, "waste paper mart" was a handy hanger for synecdoche the literary device. Old newspapers and books were always the unlikely bully in a scrap shop, elbowing even heavy metal scrap to the sidelines. In a bloodless synecdochic takeover, these fragile items proudly represented the whole of scrap materials. And the neighbourhood Kabadiwala invariably appended "waste paper mart" to their shop's name. Rajalakshmi Waste Paper Mart on East Coast Road (ECR) in Pallavakkam established 26 years ago mirrors this practice.

Its owner T. Ponraja is winding up operations at Pallavakkam, the shutters to be downed for the final time sometime next week, when he would be launching into his second innings at a new address in Injambakkam on ECR, carrying over lessons and scrap items, not all of them, certainly not the used books and stacks of old newspapers. He notes he is going to the next level, and reveals there is no room for old newspapers and books up there. "I will focus on wooden and metal scrap."

Even at Pallavakkam, the old newspapers and books were not raking in the shekels; a whole truckload of other scraps did that for Ponraja. But he would



T. Ponraja has lost faith in sale of old books as a revenue stream; and (below) Abdur Rasheed believes a demand for them continues to exist.



still display old books he received, on a metal rack right next to where he would be seated. He would not sell those books by a standard weight math, but by deliberate pricing of each individual book, turning over to see the price on the cover. He wanted book lovers to purchase from him. Over the years as smartphone models became thinner, the stacks of books coming in became correspondingly lighter. Good used

book titles were slow in making it to the shelf and slower still leaving it. He has spread out the last stack of books on the shelf. And these books might be waiting for readers that will probably never arrive. No problem with the quality of the collection; only that their time under the sun is up. "Even if I sell a book worth ₹499 for ₹100, there are no buyers," says Ponraja, believing the downward slide began during the pandemic, and is speeding as dependence on technology for information deepens by the minute. "There was a time when he would have a steady stream of customers looking for old books. Their enthusiasm motivated me to collect more books. Now, I have lost my motivation." This is a recurrent theme across neighbourhood scrap shops, many of them not drawn anymore to keeping old books for sale. And that contrasts sharply with how in the past neighbourhood Kabadiwa-

las headlined the chapter on old books in the circular economy. They would welcome old books jettisoned out of households. Sellers of old books would buy from them on the cheap, usually by weight; sometimes residents would be buyers, in which case, the price would be higher but still strikingly affordable. These books would find a cosy shelf in a new home and then again be offloaded onto a tricycle to be carted to a Kabadiwala shop.

While a majority of Kabadiwalas believe the death knell for the used books trade is progressively getting louder, do not be surprised to meet some who continue to believe in it. Abdur Rasheed runs a scrap shop at East Abhiramapuram First Street in Mylapore where a notable display is a wall-mounted metal shelf which is always populated by used books that are sold by weight, a fixed ₹80 per kg. Books might contribute to a negligible part of his income, but he still buys them as scrap, displays them prominently for sale. Explains Abdur: "There is still demand for books; there are still customers coming for books, because of which I go and fetch books. It is an amalgamation of fresh and old books, often both in good condition."

In this National Reading Month, such stories are a sliver of hope for lovers of printed books.

The bookmark shifted from a page of grief to one of growth

On Mount Road, Siva Book House tells a similar tale of loss, memory and resilience. Founded and nurtured by brothers Siva and Sundaramurthy in 1977, the bookstore located in a shopping complex on Blackers Road off Mount Road is now run by Sundaramurthy's wife, Malliga with the assistance of their son Maheshwaran. For nearly six years, the mother-son duo has kept the shelves occupied, refusing to let the bookstore become a forgotten chapter. A homemaker for most of her life, Malliga never once imagined she would one day run the very store she used to visit only to bring lunch for her husband, whom she fondly calls "my sir". It was Maheshwaran, their younger son who insisted the shop should not end with his father's passing and patiently taught her the

nuances of bookselling. She now travels across Chennai using various modes of public transport to collect books as per the trends; a routine once unknown to her now defines her life.

The store, open from 10:30 a.m. to 8:00 p.m., has a range that extends from magazines and fiction to non-fiction and academic books. Siva Book House was a prominent presence on the pavement on Mount Road just a dozen footsteps away from the Anna Salai Post Office. Overtaken by various changes that unfolded on that section, including the razing of a shopping complex, Siva Book House moved "indoors" into this shopping complex on Blackers Road. With reduced visibility, the bookstore thrives largely on the patronage of old customers.

"If someone urgently needs a book,

I will come as early as nine in the morning," Malliga smiles.

She fondly remembers how her husband handpicked every collection and occasionally took a young Maheshwaran along, unknowingly nurturing his love for books. Books entered Malliga's world through her husband's voice rather than the printed page. "My sir would narrate stories to me because I was not comfortable with reading any language," she recalls. "I may not have read them all, but I still remember every story he told." Though sales has declined with the rise of digital reading, Malliga believes technology can never replace the joy of walking into a bookstore, breathing in the scent of paper, and finding solace among the shelves. Their regular customers include teachers, government employees and media professionals.

Long after all the books on its shelves have been read, Siva Book House will have a story to be read, outside those book covers: the story of a

woman who stepped outside the confines of her home, picked up her husband's unfinished chapter and found the courage to keep writing it.

Siva Book House can be contacted at 9952934175.



Sundaramurthy and (left) Malliga.

Comfort wheels

R. RAGU

One can pass up an occasion for banqueting, but not an opportunity to be of help to someone facing bereavement or is up against a health crisis, their own or a family member's. In bereavement and health crisis that draw the attention of the wider world because of the personalities involved, P.R.M.M. Shanthakumar has made his presence felt from time to time. His company, Flying Squad Ambulance Service, which offers emergency medical, mortuary and funeral services through its fleet of vehicles, some of them massively high-end, has been called on for assistance during loss and suffering involving big names.

Shanthakumar points out that director the body of K. Bhagyaraj was transported in his company's vehicle from the Apollo Hospital to the deceased director's home in Nungambakkam.

Shanthakumar underlines that his hearse vehicles had been pressed into service for three chief ministers of Tamil Nadu, carrying their mortal bodies; they are V. R. Nedunchezhiyan (who was briefly acting CM in 1969 and again in 1987), J. Jayalithaa and 'Kalaigarnar' M. Karunanidhi.

Shanthakumar explains that in recent times he is also focussed on providing a plush space for people to carry out rituals for their dear deceased. Based on a public-private partnership (PPP), in which he has tied up with Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC), he is offering a cosy air-conditioned space for the performance of rituals and funeral service at the Jones Road burial ground in Saidapet.

A GCC official familiar with the development says a 1,200 sq.ft space was extended to him for the purpose. Shanthakumar notes the built-up area of the facility measures 2,400 sq.ft. The facility is not far from completion, and its inauguration would be announced in the near future, according to the source.

Shanthakumar has already

Kilpauk resident P.R.M.M. Shanthakumar and his team are called on for assistance during bereavement and health crisis involving celebrities. His vehicle transported director K. Bhagyaraj's body from hospital to home. In collaboration with GCC, he will be starting a funeral services facility at the Jones Road burial ground in Saidapet soon



A 5G ambulance; a funeral services facility at New Avadi Road and an upcoming one at Jones Road. PHOTOS: RAGU R. & SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT.



established a similar funeral services facility at the burial ground on New Avadi Road. These facilities being established in collaboration with Greater Chennai Corporation are headlined "Dignified Farewell".

Sixty-five-year-old Shanthakumar, a resident of Kilpauk Garden Colony in Kilpauk, reveals that became aware of the lack of ambulances and hearses when he had a ringside view of how a day goes at an auto stand outside Kilpauk medical college hospital. His father was an auto driver attached to the stand, and a young Shanthakumar, in his teens then, noticed how bodies were being transported in autos for want of hearse services.

Shanthakumar lists among his company's achievements the introduction of a women-led ambulance service, private mortuary, funeral services and pet funeral services. He draws attention to "two state-of-the-art '5G Super Smart Ambulances', equipped with the latest life-saving technologies; each machine fitted with air suspension systems, ensuring maximum comfort and stability for critically ill patients during transport." The services are offered across India, he notes. Other highlights of the services include eight paramedical Professionals, three on-call doctors to accompany patients during critical intercity and interstate transfers; and 120 staff members tasked with patient care, mortuary management and funeral support services.



Youngsters shine at Asia Triathlon championships

The triathletes were trained by an academy on East Coast Road

A group of young Indian triathletes delivered commendable performances at the 2026 Asia Triathlon Super Sprint Championships in the under-15 category.

Leading the contingent was Vinesh Rakesh, who produced an impressive performance to finish 26th out of 41 athletes with an overall time of 30 minutes and 5 seconds. Competing against some of Asia's strongest young triathletes, Vinesh, a student of GT Aloha Vidya Mandir in Injambakkam, demonstrated determination, composure, and significant progress on the international stage, said a release.

Joining him were fellow athletes Roonish Rajesh (34:56, 36th), Zoran Sinclair (35:22, 37th) and Abhijay Kumaran (36:05, 38th), all of whom successfully completed the demanding race and showcased remarkable resilience and fighting spirit.

While Roonish and Abhijay Kumaran are students of St. John's



The team with Minister Aadhav Arjuna and coach Vinolee Ramalingam

Public School and BVM Global respectively, Zoran is homeschooled.

The athletes have been training intensively for more than six months under the guidance of Vinolee Ramalingam, in Bheema Multisport Performance Academy, ECR, whose structured coaching programme has focused on developing the athletes' swimming, cycling, running, and race

execution skills.

The team also expressed gratitude for the timely financial support extended by Aadhav Arjuna and the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu. Their support played a crucial role in enabling the athletes to participate in the championship and gain invaluable experience competing against Asia's best young triathletes, added the release.

Velachery resident wins three medals in swimming

Deeksha Sivakumar, representing Tamil Nadu, won a hat-trick of medals in the 79th

Senior National championship held in Ahmedabad recently. Deeksha won gold in 4x100m mixed medley, silver in 4x100m freestyle relay and bronze in 4x200m freestyle relay events. A resident of Velachery, Deeksha is a student of Deeksha Sivakumar.

She is currently studying in SRM Institute of Science and Technology.



Four-week Yoga programme



Satyananda Yoga Centre is conducting a four-week Yoga programme from July 7 in Mambakkam, Madambakkam, Nanganallur and Velachery and KK Nagar. Time: From 5.30 a.m. to 7 a.m. According to a press release, no fee will be charged. The centre follows the curriculum of Bihar School of Yoga. Recitation of slokas and mantras are part of the programme, adds the release.

For venue details, call 9841227709 / 9176902929 / 9382577264 / 9500054370 / 8754499334 / 6383008358.

Book on an offbeat nuance of English released

The 291st meeting of the Shakespeare Millennium Club was held on June 23 with a medical camp organised exclusively for the employees of the 150 plus year-old Cosmopolitan Club. Sanjay Ramaswami, president of the Cosmopolitan Club, inaugurated the event with senior doctors from Srushti Hospitals, Rela Hospital, Lychee Healthcare Clinic, Aramba and Eljay Hearing Centre giving consultations along with blood tests for hemoglobin, sugar, calcium and thyroid along with ECG and Ultra Sound tests all free of charge.

In the evening at the Pallava Hall, a release of *What's in a "nym"?* authored by Chithra and JKS, was released by Associate Editor of *The Hindu* Prince Frederick, and first copies were received by

Muthuraja Pandian, controller, TNOU, V. Samundeeswari, CEO, Folk Arts India Foundation and V Selvaraj, IAS (retd.), president of the Shakespeare Millennium Club.

There were also expert talks on cardiology by Dr. Venketakrishnan of Rela Hospital and on stress management, by Dr. Vincent Vasanthan of Lychee, with a Q&A session too. This book on "nyms" has explained the 49 words ending in "nym" like synonym, homonym, pseudonym and contronym (which is the same word that can be used in direct opposite senses).

The book lists 100 contronyms with sample sentences that use the said contronym in both its opposing senses in the same sentence. The vote of thanks was proposed by T.D. Krishnamurthy.

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Building dreams

GRT Jewellers' scholarship programme to support 1,000 students this academic year

When Darshini first came across information about GRT Jewellers' scholarship programme on WhatsApp, she almost dismissed it as spam.

Recently, the B.Com student stood among hundreds of recipients at GRT Mahalakshmi Vidyalaya in Tiruttani, receiving support she believes will bring her a step closer to her academic goals. For students gathered on the sprawling campus, the Endowment Scholarship ceremony was about more than financial assistance. For many, it was a reminder that educational aspirations need not be limited by financial circumstances.

As part of its Corporate Social Responsibility, GRT Jewellers distributed scholarships to students in



the first phase of its 2026-27 scholarship programme. Nearly 1,000 students, including both existing and new beneficiaries, are expect-

ed to receive support this year.

G.R. Radhakrishnan, managing director of GRT Jewellers, said the initiative reflects the company's long-standing commitment to educational empowerment. He noted that the programme aims to recognise academic excellence while encouraging students to dream bigger and achieve greater heights despite financial challenges.

The initiative was launched in 2021 and has steadily expanded in scale and reach. While scholarships remain at its core, the programme increasingly focuses on students from government schools, those from economically disadvantaged families, and other underserved communities.

The initiative now includes mentorship and academic guidance to help students navigate educational and career decisions.

GRT is considering constructing a women's hostel to provide safe, affordable accommodation for women pursuing higher education away from home, the release added.

ZIMSON celebrates for collectors

Zimson, a leading multi-brand watch retailer, recently hosted 'Legacy of Time - A Father's Day Watch Collectors Meet' at V R Mall. The event was jointly conducted by Zimson, VR Mall, Chennai, and Chronoholic India, an independent watch-collectors' community, bringing together enthusiasts, collectors, and luxury lifestyle patrons for an evening dedicated to horology. Participants explored timepieces from Rado, Longines, Tissot, and Zimson, while exchanging stories, discussing collecting journeys, and discovering the craftsmanship behind renowned Swiss watch brands.

One of the highlights of the evening was an interactive watch quiz hosted by Karan Ma-



dan, founder of Chronoholic India, where participants were tested on their knowledge of watchmaking history, iconic timepieces, and horological innovations. Karan Madan said, "Watch collecting is about preserving stories, heritage, and craftsmanship. Events like these provide enthusiasts with an opportunity to learn from one another, discover exceptional timepieces, and inspire the next generation of collectors."

DG Vaishnav College bags Dr. Sivanthi Adityan Rolling Trophy

Dwaraka Doss Goverdhan Doss Vaishnav College has received the 'Madras University Dr. Sivanthi Adityan Rolling Trophy' for producing the maximum number of university players (men) for three consecutive years (2023-24, 2024-25, and 2025-26).

The institution's secretary, treasurer, sports secretary, and principal congratulated and encouraged the Department of Physical Education's directors and students for their efforts and achievements.



Workshop on organic farming



Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on organic farming in cultivation of vegetable crops on July 2.

According to a press release, the programme will focus on chemical-free methods of soil nourishment and pests management.

Also a culinary workshop on baking will be held on July 3. Various flavours of cakes such as coco, vanilla, and mango will be demonstrated.

Both the workshops will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. For details, call 044 - 29530048

Applications invited for best Tamil book award

Tamil Development Department of Government of Tamil Nadu has invited nominations for its annual award for best Tamil books. According to a press release, books published between January 1, 2025 and December 31, 2025 can apply.

Works of poetry, novel, short story, drama, history, linguistics, grammar, fine arts (music, painting, dance, and sculpture), biography, autobiography, history, epigraphy, archaeology, religion, spirituality and psychology can apply.

Also books on astronomy, mathematics, physics, chemistry, engineering, computer science, technology, environment science, veterinary science, anthropology, sociology, geography, environment, geology, law, political science, economics, commerce, and maritime and trade can apply

Books translated into Tamil from other languages can also apply.

Applications can be downloaded free of cost from the website of the department's website tamilvalarchithurai@tn.gov.in and submitted. The last date for receipt of completed applications is August 31. For details, call 044-28190412 / 28190413.

Competitions for Krishna Janmashtami

Shree Geeta Bhavan Trust is organising the inter-school competitions on July 17 and 18 to celebrate Krishna Janmashtami.

Competitions include drawing for children across classes, group bhajans for class IX to XII; solo song for classes VIII to XII, fancy dress competition for pre kg to class VI, and Gita recitation. For details, contact P. Maruthi, convenor at WhatsApp number 9176624283/ S.Baskaran 9840770809 e-mail. gbhavantrust@gmail.com

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